

RWANDA

Comprehensive Model UN Research Dossier – Rwanda

This dossier serves as a detailed research companion for MUN delegates representing **Rwanda**, equipping them with credible sources, thematic knowledge, and policy insights to perform with confidence in committee debates.

◆ Key Country Details Table

Detail	Information
Full Name	Republic of Rwanda
Short Form	Rwanda
Capital	Kigali
Region (UN)	Africa
Government Type	Presidential republic
Head of State	President Paul Kagame
Head of Government	President Paul Kagame
Currency	Rwandan Franc (RWF)
UN Member Since	1962
MUN Standing	Strong advocate for post-conflict development, gender equality, ICT for development, and regional peacekeeping—often a voice for African interests in global diplomacy.

General Book Recommendations

1. **“Foreign Policy in Post-Genocide Rwanda”** – Jonathan R. Beloff
2. **“Remaking Rwanda: State Building and Human Rights after Mass Violence”**
– Scott Straus & Lars Waldorf

3. **"A Thousand Hills: Rwanda's Rebirth and the Man Who Dreamed It"** – Stephen Kinzer
4. **"Rwanda and the New Scramble for Africa"** – Robin Philpot
5. **"Law and the Political Economy of Rwanda"** – Timothy Longman

Rwanda: UNHRC and Human Rights Resources

Source Name	Link	Why It's Useful
OHCHR Rwanda Country Page	https://www.ohchr.org/en/countries/rwanda	Core human rights treaties and UPR reviews
Universal Periodic Review – Rwanda	https://www.upr-info.org/en/review/Rwanda	Peer reviews of Rwanda's human rights record
Amnesty International – Rwanda Reports	https://www.amnesty.org/en/location/africa/east-africa-the-horn-and-great-lakes/rwanda/	Civil liberties and political prisoner data
Human Rights Watch – Rwanda	https://www.hrw.org/africa/rwanda	Authoritative NGO analysis on rights abuses
Freedom House – Rwanda Score	https://freedomhouse.org/country/rwanda/freedom-world/2023	Assesses press and civic freedoms
Minority Rights Group International	https://minorityrights.org/country/rwanda/	Tracks treatment of ethnic minorities
Committee Against Torture (Rwanda Reports)	https://tbinternet.ohchr.org/	UN evaluation of detention and policing practices
International Federation for Human Rights	https://www.fidh.org/en/region/Africa/rwanda/	Rights watchdog reports and campaigns
OHCHR Treaty Body Database	https://tbinternet.ohchr.org/	Full treaty compliance by

		Rwanda
UN Web TV – Rwanda Human Rights Panels	https://webtv.un.org/	Speeches and official responses

Title	Link	Relevance
Universal Periodic Review - Rwanda	Link	Provides an overview of Rwanda's participation in the UPR process, including reports and recommendations.
Compilation of UN Information - Rwanda	Link	Summarizes information from UN entities on Rwanda's human rights obligations and commitments.
Summary of Stakeholders' Information - Rwanda	Link	Presents perspectives from NGOs and other stakeholders on Rwanda's human rights situation.
Amnesty International Report on Rwanda	Link	Analyzes key human rights issues in Rwanda, including freedom of expression and assembly.
Human Rights Watch World Report 2025 - Rwanda	Link	Highlights human rights developments in Rwanda, focusing on political freedoms and justice.
Freedom House Report on Rwanda	Link	Assesses Rwanda's political rights and civil liberties, providing a comparative score.
OHCHR Rwanda Country Page	Link	Offers comprehensive information on Rwanda's human rights situation and OHCHR's work in the country.
UNHRC Resolution on Rwanda	Link	Presents the UNHRC's formal resolution concerning human rights in Rwanda.
UNHRC Summary Record of Rwanda's Review	Link	Official record of the proceedings and statements made during Rwanda's UPR.
Amnesty International Report 2021/22: Rwanda	Link	Provides an overview of the human rights situation in Rwanda during 2021/22.

Human Rights Watch Report: "Join Us or Die"	Link	Details Rwanda's extraterritorial repression tactics against dissidents abroad.
Freedom House: Transnational Repression Report - Rwanda	Link	Examines Rwanda's actions against exiled dissidents and critics.
Amnesty International: Repression in the Context of Elections	Link	Discusses human rights concerns during Rwanda's electoral processes.
Human Rights Watch Report: "They Threw Me in the Water and Beat Me"	Link	Highlights cases of torture and ill-treatment in Rwanda's detention facilities.
UNHCR Rwanda Country Operations	Link	Details UNHCR's work with refugees and asylum seekers in Rwanda.
Amnesty International: More Progress Needed on Human Rights Commitments	Link	Evaluates Rwanda's progress on human rights commitments.
Human Rights Watch Rwanda Country Page	Link	Provides comprehensive information on human rights issues in Rwanda.
Freedom House: Freedom in the World 2025 - Rwanda	Link	Offers an assessment of Rwanda's political rights and civil liberties.
UNHRC Report: A/HRC/47/14	Link	Contains the report of the Working Group on the UPR of Rwanda.
Human Rights Watch: Rwanda Genocide Archives Released	Link	Discusses the release of archives related to the Rwandan genocide.

Unique Aspects of Rwanda's Engagement with UNHRC

- **Post-Genocide Reconstruction:** Rwanda's journey of healing since the 1994 genocide has been a significant focus, highlighting the ongoing efforts to foster unity and reconciliation among its people.
- **Authoritarian Governance:** The Rwandan Patriotic Front (RPF), which is currently in power, has faced criticism for stifling political opposition and restricting individual freedoms.

- **Extraterritorial Repression:** Reports are surfacing that Rwanda has been going after dissidents living overseas, which is sparking worries about transnational repression.
 - **Media and Expression Restrictions:** There are serious restrictions on press freedom and expression, and journalists often deal with harassment.
 - **Judicial Independence:** There have been growing worries regarding the independence of the judiciary and whether trials are truly fair.
 - **Civil Society Constraints:** Non-governmental organizations and human rights advocates often find themselves working in tough conditions, which can really hinder their effectiveness.
 - **Electoral Environment:** Elections have often been characterized by a noticeable absence of real political competition and numerous claims of irregularities.
 - **Refugee Policies:** Rwanda's way of handling refugees has drawn both admiration and criticism, especially when it comes to how they are treated and integrated into society.
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